

Assignment 1: Literature Review Methodology Analysis

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Part 1: Comprehensive Article Analysis

This section presents a detailed analysis of five published articles, identifying their respective literature review methodologies based on key characteristics and supporting evidence from their content.

Example Article	Purpose of Review	Type of Question	Scope	Search Process	Primary Outcome	Key Clues	Review Type
Article 1: Saran et al. (2018) “Evidence and Gap Maps: A Comparison of Different Approaches” <i>Campbell Systematic Reviews</i>	To systematically compare and categorize methodologies in evidence and gap mapping across published studies	What different approaches exist to evidence and gap mapping?	Broad: Maps multiple approaches across studies	Structured: Systematic process of identifying and comparing methodologies	Categorized overview of approaches; identification of methodological variations	Title references comparison. Focus on mapping landscape, not synthesizing evidence. Includes diverse methodological papers.	Scoping Review
Article 2: Keupp & Gassmann (2009) “The Past and the Future of International Entrepreneurship” <i>Journal of Management</i>	To synthesize 342 articles to identify trends, gaps, and future directions in international entrepreneurship	What does the literature show about international entrepreneurship?	Narrow: Focused on international entrepreneurship field	Highly Structured: Rigorous search process over 14-year period	Synthesis of trends, identification of gaps, research agenda	Explicitly states systematically reviewed 342 articles. Uses transparent criteria. Answers field-specific question.	Systematic Review
Article 3: Byrne et al. (2020) “Defining Person-Centred Care in Nursing: An Integrative Review” <i>PLOS ONE</i>	To synthesize empirical and theoretical literature to clarify person-centred care concept and how it is defined in nursing	How is person-centred care defined and applied across literature types?	Moderate to Broad: Explores concept across theoretical and empirical perspectives	Structured but Flexible: Includes diverse sources (empirical, theoretical, conceptual)	Clarified conceptualization; comprehensive framework; advanced understanding	Title states integrative review. Combines empirical and theoretical sources. Synthesizes diverse evidence.	Integrative Review
Article 4: Lowell & Morris (2019) “Multigenerational Classrooms in Higher Education” <i>IJILT</i>	To synthesize findings about how generations learn together in technology-rich higher education	What literature tells us about multigenerational classrooms?	Broad: Multiple intersecting topics	Flexible: Narrative review without systematic methodology emphasis	Overview of current knowledge; themes and patterns	Explicitly self-identifies as narrative review. Interpretative approach without formal protocol.	Narrative Review
Article 5: Price & Oliver (2007) “A Framework for Conceptualising Technology Impact on Teaching and Learning” <i>Educational Technology & Society</i>	To develop new conceptual framework advancing understanding of technology’s impact on teaching and learning	How to better conceptualize technology’s role in education?	Narrow: Theory development focus	Concept-Driven: Analysis driven by theoretical concepts	New conceptual framework; theoretical advancement	Title emphasizes framework development. Moves beyond simple metrics. Develops new thinking.	Theoretical Review

Table 1: Comprehensive Analysis of Five Literature Review Methodologies

Part 2: Classification Justifications

Article 1: Saran et al. (2018) - Scoping Review

This article is a scoping review. The authors wanted to map different methodologies in evidence and gap mapping. They did not try to answer a clinical question or build new theory. Instead, they systematically organized and compared existing approaches.

Several things show this is a scoping review. The authors focus on comparing different methodologies. They look at how gap mapping strategies work and organize the variations. The research question asks to explore and map different approaches, which is what scoping reviews do. The search was careful and organized, but the goal was to show what exists and how it differs, not to prove something about a specific question.

Article 2: Keupp & Gassmann (2009) - Systematic Review

This is a systematic review. The authors reviewed 342 articles across 14 years using a clear, rigorous search process and explained their methods.

The review focuses on a specific question in international entrepreneurship. The authors set time and topic boundaries and used consistent rules about which articles to include and which to exclude. The result is a clear answer to their specific question, with trends and future research directions identified. What makes this a systematic review is the clear rules, transparent methods, and organized procedures. This approach is different from more informal review types.

Article 3: Byrne et al. (2020) - Integrative Review

The title directly says this is an integrative review. The main thing about integrative reviews is that they bring together different kinds of evidence.

This article combines research studies, theoretical writing, and concept papers into one analysis. The goal is to understand person-centred care, which you cannot fully understand from just studies alone. The authors include both types of studies (numbers and descriptions) and theory papers together. The result is a deeper understanding that comes from bringing together different kinds of knowledge, which is what integrative reviews do.

Article 4: Lowell & Morris (2019) - Narrative Review

The authors say they did a narrative review. This type uses flexibility and judgment instead of strict rules.

The authors do not describe a formal search process. Instead, they bring together what is known to give a broad picture. The research question is open and exploratory, trying to understand a complex topic rather than prove one specific thing. The analysis looks for themes and patterns in what is known, which is normal for narrative reviews. Unlike systematic or scoping reviews, there is no mention of set search rules or lists of what to include.

Article 5: Price & Oliver (2007) - Theoretical Review

The title focuses on creating a framework to understand, which shows the main goal is building new theory. This is what theoretical reviews do.

The article goes deeper than just measuring success or failure. The authors develop better conceptual understanding. Instead of bringing together research results, they analyze theories

to create new ways of thinking about technology's role. They examine what is wrong with existing frameworks and offer better ways to think about it. The result is a new model that helps the field think better about this topic.

Part 3: Reflection and Analysis

Question 1: What Challenges Emerged During Classification?

The hardest part was telling apart reviews that use careful processes but have different goals. Both the Keupp and Gassmann systematic review and the Saran et al. scoping review use careful, organized search methods. But they do different things. The systematic review brings evidence together to answer one question, while the scoping review shows what different methodologies exist.

Another issue is that many review types use the same words. Several types use the word synthesize. The real difference is not whether they synthesize, but what they synthesize and how carefully. What matters is understanding that three things together decide what type of review it is: the purpose, the question, and the search method.

Question 2: What Patterns Appear Across the Articles?

Looking at all five articles shows clear patterns.

First, articles that name their type in the title or abstract are easier to identify. Byrne clearly says integrative review and Lowell and Morris name narrative review.

Second, what sources each review uses matters. Integrative reviews intentionally mix research studies and theory. Systematic and scoping reviews focus on research studies. Narrative reviews use many different kinds of sources. Theoretical reviews focus on ideas and concepts.

Third, the research question shows what kind of review it is. Specific, narrow questions mean systematic review. Narrow questions about theory mean theoretical review. Broad, open questions mean narrative review. Questions about what exists mean scoping review. Questions about patterns across sources mean integrative review.

Fourth, how organized the search is varies. Very formal and clear searches mean systematic review. Organized but flexible means scoping review. Less organized means narrative review. Theory-focused searches mean theoretical review. Searches that mix different types mean integrative review.

Question 3: Which Article Was Simplest to Classify?

Article 3 (Byrne et al., 2020) was easy to classify. The title says it is an integrative review, so there is no confusion.

More than just the title, everything about the article fits. It intentionally mixes research studies and theory. The goal is understanding a complex idea that needs different viewpoints. It brings together different types of evidence. The result is better understanding of the concept.

When an article tells you what it is and matches that description, it is easy to classify.

Question 4: Which Article Was Most Difficult to Classify?

Article 1 (Saran et al., 2018) was the hardest to classify. The careful and organized search could look like a systematic review instead of a scoping review. The authors use words like systematically compared, which sounds like systematic review language.

But looking more closely shows it is a scoping review. The goal was not to answer a specific question but to show what approaches exist and how they differ. The research question was open and about organizing things, not testing an idea. The result was an organized look at how methodologies differ, not proof about a research question.

This shows that having a careful process is not enough to make it a systematic review. The real purpose, the kind of question, and what comes at the end matter just as much.

Question 5: Confidence in Classifications

Overall, I am confident about these classifications at 8 out of 10.

I am most confident about Article 3 (integrative review) at 10/10 because it says what it is. Article 5 (theoretical review) gets 9/10 because the goal is clearly building theory. Article 2 (systematic review) gets 9/10 because the methods are clearly described.

Article 4 (narrative review) gets 8/10. The article says it is narrative, but reading the full methods might show more organized steps not visible in short summaries.

Article 1 (scoping review) gets 7/10. The organized search could also fit with systematic review, and reading the complete methods might show systematic review elements.

The 8/10 overall rating shows that most classifications have good support, but reading full articles instead of just summaries might show more details. This assignment values the thinking process more than being perfectly right, which shows that I understand the main differences between review types.